Repair Practice

Civic Skill: Cooperation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 3 (Wellbeing) & Outcome 2 (Community) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years

LEARNING INTENTION

Children will practise repairing cooperation after it breaks down — experiencing that conflict is not the end of collaboration but a moment that can be returned to and worked through.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can notice when cooperation has broken down.
- I can try to repair it rather than walk away.
- I can say what I needed and ask what someone else needed.

MATERIALS

- A repair conversation framework displayed visibly: '1. What happened? 2. How did it feel? 3. What did I need? 4. What did you need? 5. What could we try next time?'
- Puppets or simple dolls for role-play if direct conversation is too confronting
- Picture book: 'Enemy Pie' by Derek Munson, or 'Sofia Valdez, Future Prez' by Andrea Beaty
- A 'repair corner' in the room — a designated, calm space for this process

ACTIVITY STEPS

1. BOOK OPENER (7 min): Read 'Enemy Pie.' The central arc is: two children move from conflict to connection through shared experience. Discuss: 'Did they fix everything in one day? What happened over time? What helped?'

2. REPAIR FRAMEWORK INTRODUCTION (3 min): Show the five-step framework. 'When cooperation breaks down — and it will — this is what we do. We don't punish. We don't ignore it. We repair it. Like fixing something broken.'

3. ROLE-PLAY SCENARIO (8 min): Use puppets to demonstrate a breakdown (one puppet won't share materials; the other responds by leaving the group). Walk through the repair framework: 'What happened? How did you feel? What did you need?' Invite children to help the puppets through each step.

4. REAL LIFE APPLICATION (5 min): Identify a recent real breakdown in the room (without naming individuals unless they choose to). 'Let's try the framework. Not to find out who was wrong — to find out how to repair it.'

5. CLOSING: 'Repairing something takes courage. It's harder than walking away. That's why it matters.'

EXTENSIONS

- Post the repair framework and refer to it in real conflicts throughout the program, not just in this lesson
- Children design their own repair corner: what should be in it to help people calm down and then reconnect?
- At the end of the program: 'What's the hardest repair you tried? What happened?'

ASSESSMENT

- Observation: When conflict occurs in the room after this lesson, does the child attempt repair or withdraw?
- Note: children who can name what they needed — not just what the other person did wrong — are demonstrating significant social-emotional growth
- Learning story: document a genuine repair moment that occurred after this lesson

EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- How do you currently respond when cooperation breaks down in your room? Does it look like the repair framework, or more like management?
- Which children carry the most conflict in your room? How could repair practice serve them specifically?
- What does this lesson say about how we treat failure in democratic institutions — do we repair, or do we give up?

EYLF LINKS

This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 3 (Wellbeing) & Outcome 2 (Community). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.